

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

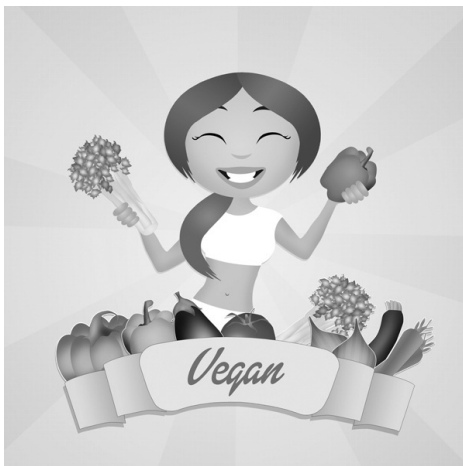
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Peter is becoming health conscious? I don't believe it!



Learning Outcome

Describe emotions and feelings in present and past situations in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think you eat healthy? Why? Why not?
- How often do you eat meat? Fruit? Vegetables?
- Are there any unhealthy foods you like to eat? Which ones?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a casual e-mail using colloquial expressions.
- I can write about cause and effect, as well as reasons for and results of an action or an event.
- I can write about unlikely or impossible situations in the present or in the future.





Let's Explore!

Peter sends a casual e-mail to John about his new diet. He's becoming **health conscious***.

* Being "health conscious" is awareness of the healthiness of one's diet and lifestyle



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Hey John, What's up? I saw Instapic photos of you at that party last weekend. Man, you know how to have a good time. When are you gonna settle down and get a real job? If I were you, I wouldn't show them to Vanessa. She's overstretched at work. Anyway, I thought I would fill you in on Cambridge gossip. I'm turning vegan! That might be a slight overstatement but after cooking vegan meals with Vanessa and Amy over the weekend, I can honestly say that I'm considering a life change. I was feeling kind of sluggish, so I decided to try something new. I'm choosing to take my health seriously since Amy and Vanessa made me more aware of the dangers of sugar and refined foods.

Essentially, vegan means no meat, eggs, dairy products or anything else derived from animals. My diet would include grains, beans, legumes, vegetables and fruits. No more meat-lovers pizza or barbecue chicken wings for me! I can only imagine the look on your face. If you weren't in shock by now, I would be surprised. I think one of the main reasons I'm prepared to start this new health kick is because I have their support. They seem to know what they're talking about and can put up with my ignorance.

Added to that, I've started a cleanse to rid my body of toxins. There is no point in embarking on new eating habits if I am not starting with a clean slate. Remember, if I had your metabolism, I wouldn't work so hard on staying fit. If you were interested, I would be happy to send you some of the recipes we used over the weekend. They were actually pretty tasty, and I'm not just saying that because I made them and they were delicious!

Your buddy,
Pete





Let's Practice!

Peter uses colloquial language in his casual e-mail.

Instructions: Choose the word or phrase from the word box to complete the sentences correctly.

Word Bank

Because / thanks to / as a result / so / for

1. I was feeling kind of sluggish, _____ I decided to try something new.
2. I think one of the main reasons I'm prepared to start this new health kick is _____ I have their support.
3. _____ of my poor eating habits, I feel tired all the time.
4. _____ my slow metabolism, I have to work hard to stay fit.
5. Peter needs to become more health conscious, _____ he is not taking care of himself.



Let's Practice!

He wants to start his new lifestyle with a clean slate.

Instructions: Unscramble the words in order to find the mystery sentence.

1. I would / to send / you / some of / If you / the recipes / we used / were interested, / over the / weekend. / be happy

2. them / Vanessa / to / I / show / were / . / if / wouldn't / I / you,

3. by now, / be surprised. / If you / in shock / I would / weren't

4. Amy, / I / I / little / be / hesitant / a / were / would / if.



Extension Activity

Time to share some good news!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 150-170 word casual e-mail to a friend or family member about current events in your life.
- Include a subject line, casual greeting and casual closing.
- Start with a general statement about what the e-mail is about.
- Use colloquial language.
- Use contractions.
- When complete, read your e-mail aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a casual e-mail about personal events.

☐ ☐

I use casual e-mail structure to communicate with friends and family.

☐ ☐

I read my casual e-mail to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to overstretch** (verb): to make excessive demands on
e.g. She's overstretched at work.
- overstatement** (noun): an exaggeration, expressing strongly
e.g. That might be a slight overstatement.
- legume** (noun): a plant with seeds such as a pea or bean plant
e.g. My diet would include grains, beans, legumes, vegetables and fruits.
- to embark** (verb): to begin a journey
e.g. There is no point in embarking on new eating habits if I am not starting with a clean slate.
- metabolism** (noun): the process used by a living thing to transform food and water to energy
e.g. Remember, if I had your metabolism, I wouldn't work so hard on staying fit.
- sluggish** (adjective): moving slowly or lazily
e.g. I was feeling kind of sluggish, so I decided to try something new.
- toxin** (noun): a poisonous substance
e.g. Added to that, I've started a cleanse to rid my body of toxins.





Learning Points

Writing tip: Writing About Cause and Effect

What makes something happen is called a cause. An effect is what happens as a result of the cause.

The purpose of cause and effect is:

To explain the reasons why something happens

To describe the results of an action, event or feeling

You use cohesive devices and linking words to express and join ideas.

Here are some words you can use in your writing to express cause and effect.

Cause	Effect
For	So
Because	For this reason
Since	For this reason
Due to	As a result
Thanks to	Consequently
As	Therefore
	Otherwise
	Thus

Examples:

- *I was feeling kind of sluggish, **so** I decided to try something new.*
- *I think one of the main reasons I'm prepared to start this new health kick is **because** I have their support.*
- *There is no point in embarking on new eating habits **because** I need to rid my body of toxins first.*
- ***As a result** of my poor eating habits, I feel tired all the time.*
- *They were actually pretty tasty, and I'm not just saying that **because** I made them.*
- ***Thanks to** my slow metabolism, I have to work hard to stay fit.*
- *Peter needs to become more health conscious, **for** he is not taking care of himself.*





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Unreal Conditional, Exceptions with I were

You use the unreal conditional to talk about situations that are not real, not possible, or not likely to happen. Although it gives an idea of what might happen if the situation were real, you never expect the condition to be fulfilled.

In written English, you use **were** in the **Present Unreal Conditional**. The form **was** is not considered grammatically correct.

In everyday conversations, **was** is often used.

You use **was** even if the pronoun is **I, he, she** or **it**.

Examples:

- If you **were** interested, I would be happy to send you some of the recipes we used over the weekend.
- If I **were** you, I wouldn't show them to Vanessa.
- If you **weren't** in shock by now, I would be surprised.
- If I **were** Amy, I would be a little hesitant.

